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JAMES SAYS DON'T MISS THIS ONE

JAMES WILD & CO. · LEDGERED & VETTED · JOURNEY DESIGN SINCE 1982

JAMES WILD & CO.

ICELAND

FIRE, ICE AND THE LONG LIGHT, IN FOUR PAGES

When to go, land or sea, and six regions worth the drive. Read it over one coffee.

"Pick the light first. The island will do the rest."

— JAMES WILD, CHIEF EXPEDITION OFFICER

JAMES WILD & CO. · I KNOW A PLACE · ICELAND · VETTED 2007

COVER: PUFFIN, LÁTRABJARG
GETTY IMAGES

HI, I'M IGGI · JAMES'S TRIP-BUILDING BUDDY

Circle what makes you grin, then find **Iggi's Compass** on the Iceland page at jameswildco.com. Tell me your month and your crew; the trip takes shape before your coffee's cold. *Never lost. Only scenic.*

01 · WHEN TO GO — PLAN · 02 / 04

Midnight sun or northern lights

May to August for long light, puffins and open Highland roads; September to April for the aurora, ice and quiet roads. There's no bad month, only a different Iceland.

	J	F	M	A	M	J	J	A	S	O	N	D
Daylight, hours	6	8	11	15	18	21	19	16	13	10	6	4
Puffins	·	·	·	·	●	●	●	●	·	·	·	·
Humpbacks	·	·	·	●	●	●	●	●	●	·	·	·
Northern lights	●	●	●	●	·	·	·	·	●	●	●	●

02 · WHO IT'S FOR — PLAN

IF YOU'RE…	GO	OUR PICK
First-timers	May–Sep	The Ring, slowly · 10 days
Families	Jun–Aug	Torfhús Retreat or Hotel Rangá
Couples & honeymooners	Sep–Mar	The Retreat, then the aurora
Hikers & photographers	Jul–Sep	Highland Base Kerlingarfjöll
Wildlife lovers	May–Aug	The north and Snæfellsnes
Sea people	May–Sep	HX · Circular Saga, 8 days



Summer: the sun barely sets GETTY IMAGES



Winter: the aurora GETTY IMAGES

> *Drive less than you think. Iceland rewards the people who stop.*
> — J. WILD

Six regions worth the drive

From where you land to the far north. Pick two or three and stay longer, rather than all six in a rush.

JAMES SAYS DON'T MISS THIS ONE



Reykjavík & Reykjanes
I'LL KNOW SOON
The Old Harbour, the Blue Lagoon, the newest lava.

Jökulsárlón
I'LL KNOW SOON
A glacier lagoon, Diamond Beach and winter ice caves.

The Westfjords
I'LL KNOW SOON
Dynjandi, Látrabjarg puffins, Arctic foxes.

The South Coast
I'LL KNOW SOON
Skógafoss, Seljalandsfoss and black sand at Vík.

Snæfellsnes
I'LL KNOW SOON
Kirkjufell, Snæfellsjökull and spring orcas.

The North
I'LL KNOW SOON
Húsavík whales, Goðafoss and Mývatn.



Jökulsárlón GETTY IMAGES



Puffins, May to August GETTY IMAGES



Kirkjufell GETTY IMAGES

The rest, in short



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BY LAND

The Ring, slowly

Ten days with a private driver-guide, five lodges, two nights in each.

● I'LL KNOW SOON



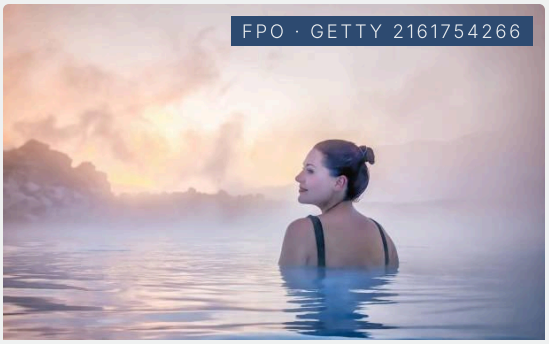
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BY SEA

Circular Saga

HX, 8 days round the coast from Reykjavík on MS Fridtjof Nansen.

● I KNOW WHO KNOWS



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BOTH

Land, then sea

Three nights in the south, then the Circular Saga. Eleven days.

● I'LL KNOW SOON · THE JAMES WILD WAY

FOUR RULES OF THE ROAD

Never drive off the road · Check vedur.is and road.is every morning · Stay 30 m back at Reynisfjara · Shower before the pool

> *Two nights in each place, never one. You don't see Iceland from the car.*
> — J. WILD

THREE WAYS
LAND & SEA
BOTH, IF YOU CAN

READY? FOLLOW MY TAIL

Tell Iggi sun or aurora.
James takes it from there.

Tap Iggi's Compass at jameswildco.com/voyages/iceland, or text James on 561.479.6355. Want the long version? Ask for the 20-page field guide.

Already have a travel advisor? We're happy to work with them. Seasons, roads and wildlife timing are guidance only. Photographs: Getty Images; FPO images are layout comps awaiting licence. Map from Natural Earth data. FL Seller of Travel ST45327 · IATAN 10783883 · Exploring Since 1982. © 2026 James Wild & Co.